

[Lesson 23](#): “Seek Learning, Even by Study and Also by Faith” (See L23 [Class Member Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To encourage us to learn “by study and also by faith” (D&C 88:118).

1. The School of the Prophets provides a pattern for us to follow in our learning.

“The Lord instructed the Prophet Joseph Smith to begin a School of the Prophets in Kirtland, Ohio. The School of the prophets began meeting in January 1833 in a small room above the Newel K. Whitney Store in Kirtland (see the picture on page 128). In this school, the leaders of the Church were instructed in gospel doctrine, the affairs of the Church, and other matters. They were to prepare for Church leadership and missionary service (D&C 88:77-80). . .

“These meetings provided the setting for spiritual experiences and in-depth discussions of gospel principles. Several revelations were received. The history of the Church records that ‘great joy and satisfaction continually beamed in the countenances of the School of the Prophets, and the Saints, on account of the things revealed, and . . . progress in the knowledge of God’ (*History of the Church*, 1:334).” (*Lesson Manual*. See [†D&C 88:117-41](#) in Enrichment Resources.) What can we do to better prepare ourselves to learn in our Church meetings?

• D&C 88:122-25. What did the Lord command the brethren in the School of the Prophets to do and not do? (See [†Carolyn G. Owen](#); [†President David O. McKay](#); and [†President Hugh B. Brown](#)) What can we learn from these verses about how to teach and learn one another?

2. We should learn “by study and also by faith.”

• D&C 88:118. Why are study and faith both necessary in our efforts to learn? (See the quotation below.)

How does faith increase our ability to learn? (See [President Harold B. Lee](#))

What are the dangers of learning without having faith in God and obeying his commandments? (See 2 Timothy 3:7; 2 Nephi 9:28-29.) [†1](#). President Marion G. Romney

What should be the relationship between gospel learning and other worthwhile study?

[†2](#). President John Taylor [†3](#). Elder Gordon B. Hinckley

3. We should continue to learn throughout our lives.

[†4](#). Elder Russell M. Nelson

Why should we learn?

What should we learn?

How can we learn?

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| • D&C 6:7. | “Seek not for riches but for wisdom”. | |
| • D&C 11:21-22. | “Seek not to declare my word, but first seek to obtain my word”. | |
| • D&C 19:23. | “Learn of me, and listen to my words”. | |
| • D&C 88:76-80, 118. | “Teach ye diligently . . . that you may be instructed . . . in theory, in principle, in doctrine”. | |
| | Seek “ye out of the best books words of wisdom; seek learning, even by study and also by faith”. | |
| • D&C 90:15. | And “become acquainted with all good books, and with languages, tongues, and people”. | |
| • D&C 93:36-37, 53. | “The glory of God is intelligence, or, in other words, light and truth.” | |
| | Obtain “a knowledge of history, and of countries, and of kingdoms, of laws of God and man”. | |
| • D&C 130:18-19. | “Whatever principle of intelligence we attain unto in this life, it will rise with us”. | |
| • D&C 131:6. | “It is impossible for a man to be saved in ignorance.” | |
| • D&C 136:32-33. | Let him learn “wisdom by humbling himself and calling upon the Lord his God”. | |

[†5](#). President Gordon B. Hinckley [†6](#). President Thomas Monson

How has your life been enriched by the study of good books? (D&C 93:15)

How can education help us serve our families and others and help us build the kingdom of God?

• D&C 68:25-28. The responsibilities of parents in Zion.

How can parents encourage children to develop a love of learning that will last throughout their lives?

What kinds of reading should we avoid? [†7](#). President Ezra Taft Benson

4. In the temple we gain an education for eternity.

• D&C 88:119. A “house of learning, a house of glory, a house of order, a house of God”.

[†8](#). Elder Boyd K. Packer [†9](#). Pres. Ezra Taft Benson [†10](#). Pres. Wilford Woodruff

Next Week: L24: “Be Not Deceived, but Continue in Steadfastness”; See L24 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. **President Marion G. Romney:** “I believe in study. I believe that men learn much through study... I also believe, however, and know, that learning by study is greatly accelerated by faith” (*Learning for the Eternities*, comp. George J. Romney [1977], 72).

†2. **President John Taylor:** “We ought to foster education and intelligence of every kind; cultivate literary tastes, and men of literary and scientific talent should improve that talent; and all should magnify the gifts which God has given unto them... If there is anything good and praiseworthy in morals, religion, science, or anything calculated to exalt and ennoble man, we are after it. But with all our getting, we want understanding and that understanding which flows from God” (*The Gospel Kingdom*, sel. G. Homer Durham [1943], 277).

†3. **Elder Gordon B. Hinckley** quoted the Savior’s injunction ‘Learn of me’ (Matthew 11:29). Then he said: “I should like to suggest that you follow that injunction given by the Son of God. With all of your learning, learn of him. With all of your study, seek knowledge of the Master. That knowledge will complement in a wonderful way the secular training you receive and give a fullness to your life and character that can come in no other way” (“[Elder Gordon B. Hinckley](#),” *Conference Report*, Oct. 1964, 118).

†4. **Elder Russell M. Nelson:** “Because of our sacred regard for each human intellect, we consider the obtaining of an education to be a religious responsibility... Our Creator expects His children everywhere to educate themselves” (“[Where Is Wisdom](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1992, 6).

†5. **Elder Gordon B. Hinckley:** “You know that your children will read. They will read books and they will read magazines and newspapers. Cultivate within them a taste for the best. While they are very young, read to them the great stories which have become immortal because of the virtues they teach. Expose them to good books. Let there be a corner somewhere in your house, be it ever so small, where they will see at least a few books of the kind upon which great minds have been nourished” (“[Opposing Evil](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1975, 39).

†6. **President Thomas S. Monson:** “A ... hallmark of a happy home is discovered when home is a library of learning... The Lord counseled, ‘Seek ye out of the best books words of wisdom; seek learning, even by

study and also by faith’ (D&C 88:118). The standard works offer the library of learning of which I speak. We must be careful not to underestimate the capacity of children to read and to understand the word of God” (“[Hallmarks of a Happy Home](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1988, 70).

†7. **President Ezra Taft Benson:** “Today, with the abundance of books available, it is the mark of a truly educated man to know what not to read... Feed only on the best. As John Wesley’s mother counseled him: ‘Avoid whatever weakens your reason, impairs the tenderness of your conscience, obscures your sense of God, takes off your relish for spiritual things, ... increases the authority of the body over the mind’” (“[In His Steps](#),” in *1979 Devotional Speeches of the Year* [1980], 61).”

†8. **Elder Boyd K. Packer:** “The temple is a great school. It is a house of learning. In the temples the atmosphere is maintained so that it is ideal for instruction in matters that are deeply spiritual...

“The temple ceremony will not be fully understood at first experience. It will only be partly understood. Return again and again and again. Return to learn. Things that have troubled you or things that have been puzzling or things that have been mysterious will become known to you. Many of them will be the quiet, personal things that you really cannot explain to anyone else. But to you they are things known...

“So look toward the temple. Point your children toward the temple. From the days of their infancy, direct their attention to it, and begin their preparation for the day when they may enter the holy temple.

“In the meantime, be teachable yourself, be reverent. Drink deeply from the teachings—the symbolic, deeply spiritual teachings—available only in the temple” (*The Holy Temple* [pamphlet, 1982], 6-8).

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder Russell M. Nelson, “[Where Is Wisdom?](#)” *Ensign*, Nov. 1992, 6.
2. Elder David A. Bednar, “[Learning to Love Learning](#),” *Ensign*, Feb. 2010, 26.
3. President Henry B. Eyring, “[Education for Real Life](#),” *Ensign*, Oct. 2002.
4. President Gordon B. Hinckley, “[The Words of the Prophet: Seek Learning](#),” *New Era*, Sep. 2007.
5. [Ted Gibbons](#), D&C Lesson 23, accessed on June 24, 2013.
6. [Nancy Jensen](#), LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, D&C Lesson 23, accessed on June 24, 2013.

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Enrichment Resources:

†9. President Ezra Taft Benson: “Do we return to the temple often to receive the personal blessings that come from regular temple worship? Prayers are answered, revelation occurs, and instruction by the Spirit takes place in the holy temples of the Lord” (“[Come unto Christ, and Be Perfected in Him](#),” *Ensign*, May 1988, 85).

†10. President Wilford Woodruff: “Do not be discouraged because you cannot learn all at once; learn one thing at a time, learn it well, and treasure it up, then learn another truth and treasure that up, and in a few years you will have a great store of useful knowledge which will not only be a great blessing to yourselves and your children, but to your fellow men” (*The Discourses of Wilford Woodruff*, sel. G. Homer Durham [1946], 269).

†D&C 88:117-41. “Organize Yourselves”

D&C Student Manual: “The School of the Prophets founded by the Lord (see D&C 86:127) was organized in February 1833. The Prophet and the Apostles and other elders were to ‘teach one another words of wisdom ... out of the best books ... by study and also by faith’ (v. 118). Those who attended ‘had many manifestations of the presence of the Spirit of the Lord,’ including speaking in foreign tongues (Smith and Sjodahl, Commentary, p. 567).

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“A ‘school in Zion’ was organized in Independence, Missouri, in August 1833 with Parley P. Pratt as its instructor (see Notes and Commentary on D&C 97:3-5), and Brigham Young patterned a school of the elders after these early schools when the Church moved to Utah.

“In the later verses of Doctrine and Covenants 88, wrote Smith and Sjodahl, ‘rules are given for the conduct of the School of the Prophets. This school was to be established for the benefit of all who were called to the ministry of the Church (v. 127). Note the order and etiquette to be observed in everything pertaining to the school. It was to be a house of God and to be respected as such.’ (Commentary, p. 567.) Though the rules of order and conduct in these verses were given specifically for the School of the Prophets, many have universal application. (In *D&C Student Manual*, Religion 324 and 325, 205.)

Carolyn G. Owen: “... ‘Intelligence is a function of righteousness.’ I picked up this comment one afternoon while loafing around a professor’s office with a lot of other people, and I encountered the same thought again several years later in a talk by Chauncey Riddle, who said, ‘Morality is the key to acquiring, keeping, and using truth and light.’ [6. Address by Chauncey Riddle, “The Potential of Man,” given at BYU 9 April 1975.] ... Generally applied, the theory can be awkward to defend, since the world is so full of a number of bright, wicked people; but I have never been able to simply dismiss the proposition.” (In “[Book Learning](#),” *Ensign*, Sep. 1983.)

President David O. McKay: “Gaining knowledge is one thing and applying it, quite another. Wisdom is the right application of knowledge; and **true education—the education for which the Church stands—is the application of knowledge to the development of a noble and Godlike character.**

“A man may possess a profound knowledge of history and of mathematics; he may be an authority in psychology, biology, or astronomy; he may know all the discovered truths pertaining to geology and natural science; but if he has not with this knowledge that nobility of soul which prompts him to deal justly with his fellow men, to practice virtue and holiness in personal life, he is not a truly educated man.

“**Character is the aim of true education;** and science, history, and literature are but means used to accomplish the desired end. Character is not the result of chance work but of continuous right thinking and acting.” (*Gospel Ideals: selections from the discourses of David O. McKay*, Salt Lake City: Improvement Era, 1953), pp. 440-41.)

President Hugh B. Brown: “Wherever in life great spiritual values await man’s appropriation, only faith can appropriate them. Man cannot live without faith, because in life’s adventure **the central problem is character-building—which is not a product of logic, but of faith in ideals and sacrificial devotion to them.**” ([Conference Report](#), Oct. 1969, 105)

President Harold B. Lee: “We would remind you that the **acquiring of knowledge by faith is no easy road to learning.** It will demand strenuous effort and a continual striving by faith...

“In short, **learning by faith** is no task for a lazy man. Someone has said, in effect, that such a process **requires the bending of the whole soul**, the calling up of the depths of the human mind and linking them with God—the **right connection must be formed. Then only, comes ‘knowledge by Faith.’**” (“Installation of and Charge to the President,” *Inaugural Addresses* (Provo, Utah: Brigham Young University Press, 1971), p. 15.)

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